

Smooth talker

Speechwriters use particular techniques to create interesting speeches that will engage an audience. Most importantly, they consider what the words will sound like when they are spoken out loud.

Rhetorical questions

Sometimes, a speaker will ask the audience a question, often without expecting an answer. Posing questions makes listeners feel involved and encourages them to think about something in depth.

You say that you hate Brussels sprouts, but have you ever given them a chance?

Repetition and lists

Repeating words and phrases gives a speech a good rhythm and emphasizes important words and ideas. Patterns of three are particularly common in speech writing. Listing subjects, places, or names can reinforce how many there are of something.

Sprouts are bursting with goodness. They are packed with vitamin C, vitamin A, potassium, calcium, iron, and protein.

REAL WORLD

I would also like to thank...

Actors often give speeches when they win prizes at awards ceremonies. The Academy Awards have become famous for having overly long and emotional speeches. The record for the longest speech is still held by Greer Garson, who rambled on for seven minutes in 1942. Since then, ceremony organizers have imposed a 45-second rule, so speeches longer than 45 seconds are cut off by the orchestra.



Emotive and sensational language

A speech isn't just a list of events or a logical argument. It needs to appeal to the audience. Speechwriters use emotive language to evoke a response in the audience, such as sympathy, guilt, or excitement.

Every year, thousands and thousands of untouched Brussels sprouts are thoughtlessly dumped in the trash.

Pronouns

Using the pronouns *I*, *you*, or *we* in a speech can make it more personal. Speakers also use friendly terms of address, such as *friends* or *comrades*, to relate to the audience.

I changed my mind about Brussels sprouts. You can, too. Together we can make this vegetable popular again.

Slogans

Speeches often contain memorable statements called slogans, which sum up an argument. They are usually short and powerful, and sound good when spoken out loud, often because they use alliteration.

Bring back the Brussels!

The best speeches are often **short**. **Abraham Lincoln's Gettysburg Address**, one of the most famous speeches in history, lasted for less than **three minutes**.